



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF ARTS AND BACHELOR OF EDUCATION ARTS

ALT 211: EAST AFRICAN DRAMA AND POETRY

BY RAVINE OCHTENG; 0742600411

1ST SEMESTER 2024/2025

TIME: 2 HOURS

INSTRUCTIONS:

Answer **THREE** questions in all

Question One is compulsory

1. a) "The assertion by the colonisers that poetry did not exist in East Africa prior to introduction of literacy is a fallacy." Provide facts to support this assertion. (15 marks)
b) With reference to any East African drama discussed in this course, discuss the way East African playwrights capture the history of the region in their drama(s) (15 marks)
2. Discuss the dramatization of East Africa's socio-political and cultural situation in either Francis Imbuga's *The Green Cross of Kafira* or Austin Bukenya's *The Bride*. (15 marks)
3. Drawing your illustrations from Ibrahim Hussein's *Kinjeketile* show the place of mythical powers in fighting for independence among the East African rulers (15 marks)
4. Drawing illustrations from one major East African poet, show how their poetry acts as a postcolonial pointer to the East African situation after the attainment of flag independence (15 marks)
5. Drawing your illustrations from Rebecca Njau's *The Scar* demonstrate how gender considerations are contextualized in the historical narrative (15 marks)



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF ARTS

ALT 201: EASTERN AFRICAN POETRY AND DRAMA

1ST SEMESTER 2024/2025

TIME: 2 HOURS

BY RAVINE OCHIENG; DELEGATE

INSTRUCTIONS: ANSWER QUESTION ONE AND ANY OTHER TWO QUESTIONS.

1. Using specific examples for illustration, discuss the development of written poetry and drama in Eastern Africa. (30 marks)
2. Which themes are common to East African poetry and drama? Use illustrations from the works studied as you explain. (20 marks)
3. Draw up a comparison between a poem and a play, both studied in this unit, to show how the same theme has been treated. (20 marks)
4. (i) Concisely draw up the story line in one of the plays studied in this unit. (10 marks)
(ii) Critically analyse the play. (10 marks)
5. (i) Reproduce from memory one of the poems studied in this unit. (10 marks)
(ii) Critically analyse the poem. (10 marks)

KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF ARTS AND BACHELOR OF EDUCATION (ARTS)

ALT 201: EAST AFRICAN POETRY AND DRAMA

BY RAVIVE OCTOBER

1ST SEMESTER 2023/2024

TIME: 2Hours

INSTRUCTIONS: Answer Question ONE and any other TWO questions

- a) The colonisers advanced the narrative that poetry did not exist in Africa prior to their coming to the region. Respond to this assertion using succinct examples to support your argument. [15 marks]
- b) Discuss how drama was used by the colonisers in reinforcing their colonial ideologies into the minds of East Africans. [15 marks]
2. Discuss the dramatization of East Africa's socio-political and cultural situation in either Francis Imbuga's *The Green Cross of Kafira* or Austin Bukenya's *The Bride*. [20 marks]
3. Drawing your illustrations from Ibrahim Hussein's *Kinjekitile*, show the place of culture and mythical powers in acquisition and maintenance of power in East Africa set up. [20 marks]
4. Drawing illustrations from Henry Barlow's poem(s), show how his poetry depicts the postcolonial East African situation after the attainment of flag independence. [20 marks]
5. Through an historical narrative, Rebecca Njau's *The Scar* contextualises gender concerns in East Africa. Respond on the assertion above with close reference to the play.

1a) Its worth mentioning that Africa had diverse, vibrant poetic traditions, both oral & long before colonial intrusion. Its only that the colonisers simply failed to recognise and value African forms of expression. For instance in W.A, existed the griots in Mali and Senegal for the famous Epic of Sundiata that predated European colonialism. [20 marks]

S.A: 12bungal praise poems to celebrate deeds & bugs & hammer
W.A: Mali & Senegal; Epic of Sundiata; contain authentic language & historical illustrations
E.A: Swahili literature; utenzi poems
N.A: Egyptian poems; custom on papyrus reeds.

INVOLVEMENT IN ANY EXAMINATION IRREGULARITY SHALL LEAD TO DISCONTINUATION



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY
EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF ARTS

ALT 211: EAST AFRICAN POETRY AND DRAMA

1ST SEMESTER 2023/2024

TIME: 2 Hours

INSTRUCTIONS:

- Answer Question ONE and any other two others
- 1. With appropriate illustrations, examine the factors that aided the growth and development of poetry and Drama in East Africa. (24 marks)
- 2. Interrogate how the playwright uses style to highlight main issues in *Shreds of Tenderness* by John Ruganda and *Kinjeketile* by Ebrahim Hussein. (18 marks)
- 3. Using any two poems studied in this unit, discuss five major themes captured by East African poets. (18 marks)
- 4. Lawino, in *Song of Lawino* by Okot P'Bitek speaks in defense of many aspects of African Traditional way of life. Write an essay to demonstrate the validity of this statement. (18 marks)
- 5. Examine the portrayal of the female protagonist in either *Aminata* by Francis Imbuga or *The Scar* by Rebecca Njau. (18 marks)

SIR OTONDE MICHAEL -DELEGATE



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF ARTS

AFRICAN EAST AFRICAN POETRY AND DRAMA

1st SEMESTER 2022/2023

TIME: 2 Hours

INSTRUCTIONS

Answer THREE questions

(Question ONE is Compulsory)

1. East African works of poetry and Drama incorporate themes that characterise the region. Explain this using any three texts studied in this course. (30 marks)
2. Attempt a critical analysis of a poem by any East African poet studied in this course. (20 marks)
3. Examine the theme of colonization in Stanburth Mbasia's *Kinjeketile*. (20 marks)
4. Discuss the portrayal of the female protagonist in either *The Scap* by Rebecca Njeri or *Aminata* by Frank Mbugi. (20 marks)
5. Discuss the use of style and language in *Shed of Tenderness* by John Ruganda. (20 marks)



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF ARTS

ALT 201: EAST AFRICAN POETRY AND DRAMA

BY RAVINE OCHIENG; 0742600411

1ST SEMESTER 2022/2023

TIME: 2 Hours

INSTRUCTIONS:

(i) Answer THREE questions in all.

(ii) Question ONE is Compulsory.

1. a) Orality has been a prominent feature of style in East African Poetry. With clear examples show how East African Poets have utilized orality to present their agenda of proving the existence of Poetry in East Africa prior to coming of the Whiteman. Use three relevant poems of your choice. (15 marks)
- b) With reference to any East African drama discussed in this course, discuss the way East African playwrights captures the history of the region in their Drama(s). (15 marks)
2. Discuss the dramatization of East Africa's socio-political and cultural situation in either Francis Imbuga's *The Green Cross of Kafira* or Austin Bukonya's *The Bride*. (20 marks)
3. Drawing your illustrations from Ibrahim Hussein's *Kinjeketile* show the place of culture and mythical powers in appropriating and maintaining power among the East African rulers. (20 marks)
4. Draw illustrations from Henry Barlow's poem(s), show how his poetry acts as a postcolonial pointer to East African situation after the attainment of flag independence. (20 marks)
5. Drawing your illustrations from Rabecca Njau's *The Scar* demonstrate how gender considerations are contextualized in the historical narrative. (20 marks)

SIR OTONDE MICHAEL -DELEGATE



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS 2020/2021

FIRST SEMESTER EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF ARTS

ALT 201: EAST AFRICAN POETRY AND DRAMA

DATE: MONDAY 14TH JUNE 2021

TIME: 8.00 A.M - 10.00 A.M

INSTRUCTIONS:

- Q1. Discuss the development of written EA. Poetry and Drama in the 20th Century. (30 marks)
- Q2. Using poems studied in this unit, discuss five themes common to EA. Literature. (20 marks)
- Q3. What lessons do we learn when reading Rebeka Njau's *The Scar*?
- Q4. How does Austin Bukenya "The Bride" compare with Aristotle's idea about Drama?
- Q5. Analyse any one poem studied in this course (20 marks)



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS 2017/2018

FIRST SEMESTER EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF
BACHELOR OF EDUCATION AND BACHELOR OF ARTS

ALT 201: EAST AFRICAN POETRY AND DRAMA

BY RAVINE OCHENG, DELEGATE

DATE: Tuesday, 30th January 2018

TIME: 8.00 a.m. - 10.00 a.m.

INSTRUCTIONS:

- i) Answer question 1 (ONE) and any other two questions.
- ii) Materials used in one question should not be replicated.

1. Referring to any one play and any two poems studied in this course discuss the salient features in East African Poetry and Drama. (26 marks)
2. Discuss how in your view Okot p'Bitek has benefited from African oral literary traditions in Song of Lawino. (22 marks)
3. Discuss Ibrahim Hussein's social vision in his play Kinjeketile. (22 marks)
4. Attempt a critical appreciation of Richard Nturu's poem "Introduction". (22 marks)
5. Discuss the emerging issues in East African drama. Give examples from Francis Imbuga's The Return of Mgofu or The Successor. (22 marks)



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY
UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS 2010/2011
INSTITUTE OF OPEN LEARNING
EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF ARTS
ALT 201: EAST AFRICAN POETRY AND DRAMA

DATE: Monday 31st January, 2011

TIME: 11.00 a.m. – 1.00 p.m.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Answer any **THREE** questions.
2. You are advised to be clear and precise.

1. Which prevalent themes do East African poets and play wrights address?
2. Analyze John Ruganda's *The Burdens* as a social critique.
3. Discuss the use of satire in Francis Imbuga's play, *Betrayal in the City*.
4. How does Ibrahim Hussein treat History as a theme in his play, *Kinjeketile*?
5. Using at least two poems you read in this course analyse the theme of social oppression as represented by East African poets.
6. Using any poem you read in this course discuss how effectively the poet has employed stylistic devices to deliver his/her message.

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KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS 2009/2010

INSTITUTIONAL SCHOOL BASED PROGRAMME (IBP)

EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF ARTS AND

BACHELOR OF EDUCATION

By RAHVE OCHIENG, DELEGATE

ALT 201: EASTERN AFRICAN POETRY AND DRAMA

DATE: Wednesday 28th April 2010

TIME: 8.00a.m – 10.00a.m

INSTRUCTIONS:

Answer question one and two others

Question One

Read the following poem carefully and give a critical appreciation

At A Zebra Crossing

Pedestrians crash into each other
(not with any intended harm)
and curse bitterly as they rush
to either side of the road:

- 5 It is the evening crucial hour
when each one of them
hurries to secure a place
for the unpredictable night.
Suddenly, within the grace period

SIR OTONDE MICHAEL -DELEGATE

10 A woman holds her child
against a sightless Kenya bus
In an attempt to live another day-

Two generations smashed in an instant:
The buss driver took off

15 to escape the wrath of tramps;
he clung desperately to his single life

While along the Zebra Crossing
lay mother against child
in steaming mixture of red and white
20 awaiting the next of kin.

The police and the ambulance
arrived in speedy procession
to take details of those
who would never ever hear the case!

25 But duty had been done
certified in black and white;
the on lookers had no more to watch
save the clock-tower which stood in silence.

Question Two

How did the Kamirithu Saga at the end of Kenyatta regime help to develop or hinder the development of drama in Kenya.

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2. Read the following poem carefully and respond to it in terms of its relevance to the contemporary society.

CRISPIN HAULI *The Song of the Common Man*

They drive me along,
 they do they do,
These my brothers no longer brothers -
Their hands are whips, along they drive me,
No longer am I the same mother's child.

They push me along,
 indeed they do,
These my sisters no longer sisters -
Their mouths are cannons, spittle of fire,
No longer am I the same father's pride.

They kick me along,
 they do they do,
These my playmates no longer playmates -
Their actions are fates, my life they decide,
No longer am I the same free-born human.

They abuse me,
 they do time and again,
Fellow humans load me with all their bundles -
They are my masters, and me a poor ass,
To be driven, pushed, kicked and abused.

3. What are major thematic concerns of the poets studied in this unit. Illustrate your answer appropriately.

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SECTION B: DRAMA

4. In the play The Trial of Dedan Kimathi by Ngugi wa Thiong'o and Micere Mugo, show how the characters reveal the themes.
5. Discuss how John Ruganda uses stylistic devices to capture our interest in his play, The Burdens.
6. Kinjekile by Ebrahim Hussein is a historical play. Discuss.



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS 2009/2010

OPEN, DISTANCE AND E-LEARNING EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE

OF BACHELOR OF ARTS

ALT 201: E.A. POETRY AND DRAMA

DATE: Monday 19th July, 2010

TIME: 2.00 p.m. – 4.00 p.m.

BY RAVINE OCHIENG

INSTRUCTIONS

Answer any 3 questions. You must answer at least ONE question from each section.

SECTION A: POETRY

1. Illustrating from specific poems-studied in this unit, discuss the influence of the oral traditions on E. African Poetry.
2. Drawing examples from Cook and Rubadiri's Poems from E. Africa discuss any 3 major themes that have pre-occupied E. African poets.

SECTION B: DRAMA

3. Referring to Ngugi and Mugo's The Trial of Dedan Kimathi discuss the concept of heroism in East African drama.
4. "The East African dramatist is pre-occupied with post-colonial themes". Illustrate the validity of this assertion drawing from any texts read in this unit.
5. Discuss the influence of culture in the thematic choices of East African playwrights.
6. Drawing from John Ruganda's Floods, discuss the symbolic representation of the East African experience in drama.



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS 2009/2010

FIRST SEMESTER EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF
EDUCATION AND BACHELOR OF ARTS

ALT 201: EAST AFRICAN POETRY AND DRAMA

DATE: WEDNESDAY, 23RD DECEMBER 2009

TIME: 8.00 A.M. - 10.00 A.M.

INSTRUCTIONS:

BY RAVIVE OCHENG, DELEGATE
Answer any Three questions.

You must answer a question from each section.

SECTION A: POETRY

1. Read the following poem and critically analyze it in terms of style.

RALPH BITAMAZIRE *I Love You, My Gentle One*

I love you, my gentle one;
My love is the fresh milk in the rubindi
Which you drank on the wedding day;
My love is the butter we were smeared with
To seal fidelity into our hearts
You are the cattle-bird's egg,
For those who saw you are wealthy,
You are the paprus reed of the lake,
Which they pull out with both hands.
And I sing for you with tears
Because you possess my heart:
I love you, my gentle one.

Question Three

"Dedan Kimathi was not as a heroic fighter as Ngugi wa Thiong'o at Michere Mugo has tried to portray in the TRIALS OF DEDAN KIMATHI but a coward who surrendered to British. Discuss.

Question Four

In what ways do you think that the Kenyatta succession politics influenced the writing of THE SUCCESSOR by Francis Imbuga.

Question Five

"The Bride by Austine Bukenya rotates around major character" Discuss.

Question Six

In what ways does Oriomra manipulates succession politics in the SUCCESSOR by Francis Imbuga.